FINISH-DATE CONFIDENCE

FieldFlow Service Cloud (sample)

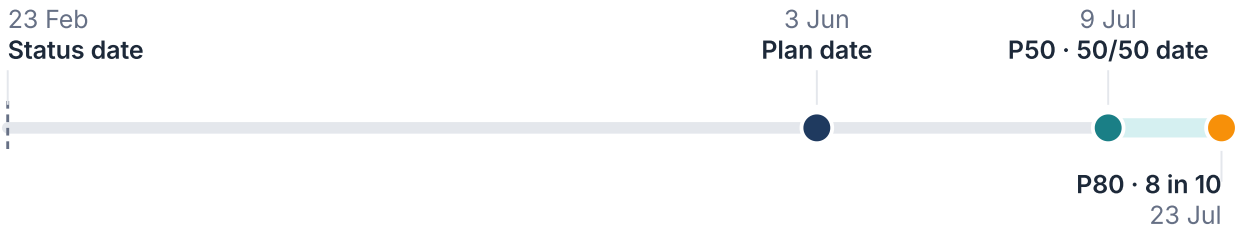
Brightwater (fictional) · Finish-date confidence · Prepared by Alex Morgan

Harbour & Pine

AMBER

AS OF
23 Feb 2027

PLAN DATE	P50 · 50/50 DATE	P80 · 8 IN 10	TRACK RECORD
3 Jun	**9 Jul**	**23 Jul**	**1.23x**
Forecast finish in the plan · 72 working days from the status date	Half the replays finish by then · +26 wd on plan	8 in 10 replays finish by then · +36 wd on plan	Actual time over baselined time, 13 completed tasks



IN ONE SENTENCE

13 completed tasks took on average 1.23x their baselined time. If the remaining work behaves the same way, and parallel work waits for its slowest path, the 50/50 date is 9 Jul (P50); 8 in 10 replays finish by 23 Jul (P80). The current plan date of 3 Jun is earlier than either. This ignores new scope and risks not yet in the plan.

> P80 likely optimistic: the latest phase with enough history (Build and configure, 1.32x) is running slower than the earlier ones, so remaining work may be riskier than the average.

How this is calculated

Keelson measured how long each of the 13 completed tasks with a baseline start, baseline finish and actual finish really took against its baselined working days, then replayed the remaining 72 working days of work 5,000 times. The order of that work comes from the plan's dates: a task that starts the working day after another finishes waits for it; one that starts straight after another phase ends waits for that whole phase. In each replay every remaining task overruns like a completed task picked at random (overdue open tasks included, at no less than they have run so far), at a pace resampled from the history with an allowance for the rest of the project running faster or slower. Parallel work finishes when its slowest path does. P50 is the date half the replays finish by; P80 the date 8 in 10 finish by. Working days are Mon–Fri. Checked on 1,000 simulated projects (P80 held in 81%, P50 in 53%); not yet validated on real project histories. Dependencies are inferred from dates; a Predecessors column, if present, is not used yet.

Assumptions

- Remaining work grows like completed work did: the same spread of overruns and underruns.
- Task order is read from the plan's dates; lags and start-to-start links are missed.
- New scope and named risks are not modelled; add them to the plan to see their effect.
- The spread is understated if the remaining work is riskier than the work done so far.

Track record by phase

PHASE	TASKS	ACTUAL / BASELINE
Initiation	3	Under 5 tasks
Discovery and design	5	**1.19x**
Build and configure	5	**1.32x**

> A range, not a promise: P50 and P80 describe how this project has behaved so far, not what it will do. +n wd = working days (Mon–Fri) later than the plan date.